

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy, some rain and snow, high 40. **Tonight**, partly to mostly cloudy, low 32. **Tomorrow**, plenty of clouds, colder, some flurries, high 37. Weather map appears on Page B12.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,767

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SATURDAY, JANUARY 17, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

Agent’s Path From Iraq War To Minneapolis

ICE Makes Transition to Military Mind-Set

By KATIE J.M. BAKER

Jonathan Ross stood before a small group of his fellow students at Anderson University in Indiana and cautioned that the war in Iraq was not the one they were seeing on television.

It was April 2006, Ross, then 23, was recently back from a National Guard deployment to Iraq, speaking at a “Support the Troops” event hosted by the College Republicans. Mr. Ross showed the students photos of charred Humvees and walls pockmarked with bullet holes.

“We just got armor from the dump,” he said, describing how they outfitted their vehicles. “They didn’t supply us with the trucks you see on the news at all.”

Twenty years later, Mr. Ross, now an agent with Immigration and Customs Enforcement, is once again on the front lines of a polarizing mission: the Trump administration’s aggressive immigration crackdown in Minnesota.

On Jan. 7, during an enforcement surge in south Minneapolis, Mr. Ross fired three shots into a moving S.U.V., killing Renee Good, a 37-year-old mother of three. Her partner, Becca, who recorded the standoff on her phone, later said the couple had “stopped to support our neighbors” after federal agents were spotted in their neighborhood.

President Trump and other federal officials have said that Mr. Ross acted in self-defense when he killed Ms. Good, and have accused her of driving at him or even running him over. Minnesota officials have called the administration’s accounts “propaganda” and “garbage.” (A New York Times analysis of videos of the shooting contradicts the claim that Mr. Ross was run over, and suggests Ms. Good was steering away from him at the time he opened fire.)

Chris Madel, a Republican candidate for governor of Minnesota, *Continued on Page A13*



Multiple Views of a Fateful Moment

Newly available videos and existing footage synchronized and analyzed by The New York Times provide a frame-by-frame look at how an ICE officer ended up shooting and killing a motorist in Minneapolis. Page A12.

Powell’s Armor: A Groundswell Built With Care

By COLBY SMITH

Jerome H. Powell had a list. It included the names of members of Congress whom the Federal Reserve chair expected to have his back after finally taking on President Trump following the unthinkable — a criminal investigation by the Justice Department.

Mr. Powell’s belief that he would find a groundswell of support was not an idle thought. It was the product of years of deliberate relationship-building on Capitol Hill since Mr. Trump first elevated Mr. Powell to lead the central bank in his first term.

Mr. Powell was in touch with numerous lawmakers after the central bank received grand jury subpoenas on Jan. 9, including Senators Susan M. Collins of Maine and Lisa Murkowski of Alaska. He also spoke with one of the Fed chair’s harshest Republican critics, Senator Kevin Cramer of North Dakota, who sits on the powerful Senate Banking Committee.

Mr. Cramer said in an interview that he had spoken to Mr. Powell on Sunday before the Fed chair confronted the Trump administration in an extraordinary video message. They discussed the stakes of the criminal investigation and the potential connection to the president’s pressure campaign to force the central bank to *Continued on Page A15*

In Pile of Pardons, Second Reprieve for Fraudster

By KENNETH P. VOGEL and SUSANNE CRAIG

WASHINGTON — In 2021, a convicted fraudster named Adriana Camberos was freed from prison when President Trump commuted her sentence.

Rather than taking advantage of that second chance, prosecutors said, Ms. Camberos returned to crime. She and her brother were convicted in 2024 in an unrelated fraud.

This week, Mr. Trump pardoned both siblings, marking the second time Mr. Trump had opened the prison gates for Ms. Camberos.

Their pardons were among a handful of clemency grants quietly issued by Mr. Trump on Thursday and Friday.

Among the other recipients: a man whose daughter had given millions to a Trump-backed super PAC, a former governor of Puerto Rico and a former F.B.I. agent — all of whom had pleaded guilty in a political corruption case.

The pardons, most of which have not been previously reported, were supported by people with close ties to Mr. Trump’s orbit, including lawyers who had worked for him.

They continue a trend in which Mr. Trump has used the unfettered presidential clemency *Continued on Page A15*

President Quietly Issues Clemency Grants

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Striking Nurses Cite Job Safety as Priority

Nurses continued a walkout Friday in New York, seeking better staffing, pay and security. Page A17.

Trump Pushes To Retain Coal On Power Grid

Older Electricity Plants Told to Stay Open

By CLAIRE BROWN and BRAD PLUMER

Over the past eight months, the Energy Department has taken the extraordinary step of ordering that generators at five coal-burning power plants that had been headed for retirement stay open and keep running.

That’s just the beginning, officials say.

At a White House event on Thursday, Trump administration officials said they planned to keep open as many coal plants as they could and prevent any further retirements over the next three years.

“The goal is to stop the political closure of coal plants,” Chris Wright, the energy secretary, said during the first meeting of the National Coal Council, which had lapsed under the Biden administration but which President Trump has revived. Dozens of representatives from the coal industry were present.

The moves are part of a sweeping plan by Mr. Trump to revive America’s coal industry, which has been declining for years. Mr. Trump has expressed a certain affection for the fuel, calling it “beautiful clean coal” to goad environmentalists, who note that coal is the dirtiest of fossil fuels and a major driver of global warming.

Administration officials say that keeping coal plants open is necessary to avoid blackouts and meet rising energy needs.

On the ground, however, efforts to halt coal retirements are already causing complications. Two of the coal units that the Energy Department ordered to stay online in December are broken, and it’s unclear when they might be repaired.

Some plants that were ordered to keep running had already shuttered their coal mines and stopped maintaining old equipment. Now, utilities and operators are straining to revive them. The costs of extending coal-burning plants are significant, and federal and state regulators are embroiled in disputes over who will ultimately pay.

“These are old plants, and they are expensive to refurbish and keep open,” said Ari Peskoe, director *Continued on Page A14*

TEHRAN PROTESTS CURBED AS FORCES FILL THE STREETS

A FEEL OF MARTIAL LAW

Authorities Sowing Fear With Heavy Presence of Armed Patrols

This article is by *Abdi Latif Dahir, Kiana Hayeri, Sanam Mahoozi and Farnaz Fassihi.*

BEIRUT — A heavy police presence and deadly crackdowns on protesters appeared to have largely suppressed demonstrations in many cities and towns across Iran, according to several witnesses and a human rights group.

For weeks, Iran has been convulsed by protests sparked by a collapsing economy and a currency in free fall, with the demonstrations snowballing into a broader antigovernment movement. The authorities have sought to quell the protests with brutal force and have plunged the country into a communications blackout that has made it difficult to know what’s happening.

Four residents reached by The New York Times in the capital, Tehran, said that the streets had mostly been quiet of protests this week as the severity of the crackdown and the high number of casualties became clear. Security forces were deployed in large numbers to nearly every neighborhood, said the residents, who lived in different parts of the city.

All four spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of reprisal. They said that it felt as if the capital was under martial law, with the typically bustling and traffic-clogged streets largely empty. Shops and restaurants in some areas were closed after 6 p.m.

“There is massive disappointment and disillusionment,” said another resident, who worked in central Tehran and also spoke on the condition of anonymity.

There have been no large-scale protests documented in Iran since Sunday, according to Arina Moradi and Mina Khani, members of the Norway-based Hengaw Organization for Human Rights, which has been monitoring the demonstrations since they began.

Ms. Moradi said in an interview that a heavy military and security *Continued on Page A5*

Stock Investment Tip for 2026: ‘Don’t Fight the White House’

By JOE RENNISON

President Trump’s administration is having a big influence on the stock market at the start of 2026.

The U.S. attack on Venezuela sent the value of some oil stocks surging. Mr. Trump’s social media post calling for a cap on credit card interest rates caused the stocks of credit card issuers to slump. And after the president proposed new requirements governing Nvidia’s computer chip sales to China, that tech giant’s stock also fell, weighing on the rest of the market.

Historically, many analysts had concluded that the person in the White House didn’t much matter to stocks, and certainly less than the Federal Reserve and where it would set interest rates.

But investors’ reactions to Mr. Trump’s recent pronouncements have left some wondering, for now at least, whether the White House is becoming more of a market mover.

“The adage used to be ‘Don’t fight the Fed,’” said Hardika Singh, a stock analyst at Fundstrat. “This year I think it will be ‘Don’t fight the White House.’”

There have been periods like this before under President Trump. In April, for example, his initial tariff proposals sent the stock market into a tailspin. But so far this year, Mr. Trump has been driving big stock moves in specific sectors, while the S&P 500 has risen just 1 percent.

One of those sectors is the oil industry. The Trump administration has said it intends to sell 30 million to 50 million barrels of Venezuelan oil, “controlled by me, as President of the United States of America, to ensure it is used to benefit the people of Venezuela and the United States,” Mr. Trump said in a social media post.

Oil executives have expressed misgivings about returning to Venezuela after the U.S. military ousted Nicolás Maduro this month. But Mr. Trump’s bullishness on Venezuelan oil has sent the energy sector of the S&P 500 up 7.5 percent for the year through Thursday.

SLB and Halliburton lead the gains, up over 20 percent and 15 *Continued on Page A14*

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Claire Brosseau says mental illness has made her life unbearable. She wants a medically assisted death. PAGE A8

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President Trump backs the remnants of the Maduro regime. Below, a Nobel Prize replica. News Analysis. PAGE A6



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Systems like OpenAI’s GPT-5 are accelerating research in math and biology. But there is a debate over whether they can do that work on their own. PAGE B1

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A celebrated food magazine is back, with new leadership and zero approval from its original owner. PAGE B1

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Money Where His Mouth Is
The Kid Mero, a podcast star from the Bronx, is the new morning host on New York’s premier hip-hop station. PAGE C1



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Harvard still dominates, but as Beijing pours billions into research universities, grant cuts by President Trump could accelerate a trend in which U.S. schools are falling behind global peers. PAGE A11

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Amid rising fear among some New York Jews, the new City Council speaker, Julie Menin, proposed setting up 100-foot buffer zones at houses of worship and schools during protests. PAGE A16

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For Seattle to make a Super Bowl run, the mercurial Sam Darnold must conquer his demons. The Seahawks aren’t about to rein him in now. PAGE B6

